

PSCI 3350.001 Comparative Politics

Lecture 3: Economics and political development

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Today's puzzle

Does economic development cause political development — and if it does, in which direction does the causal arrow run?

Ishiyama surveys **three answers** that disagree about almost everything: where to look, what the unit of analysis is, and whether the Western path can be repeated at all.

Learning goals

By the end of class you should be able to:

1. State what **modernization theory** claims and name the main versions of “political development” inside it
2. Distinguish **social mobilization** from **political institutionalization**, and explain why Huntington needs both
3. Explain how **dependency theory** inverts the modernization story
4. Say what **statism** adds that neither of the other two can explain
5. Compare all three on the dimensions in Table 3.4

Part I: Modernization theory

Older than political science

Modernization theory is “less a coherent theory than an approach.” Its roots run back to the Enlightenment conviction that people can change their own conditions.

Condorcet

Technology and economic transformation let humankind alter its moral and cultural values

Saint-Simon (1760–1825)

Economic development and technology can better social conditions

Comte (1798–1857)

Modernization ushers in a “positive” scientific era

Marx

Industrialization of the economic **base** changes the social and political **superstructure**

The common thread: **economic change comes first, and political change follows.**

Durkheim: complexity and anomie

Durkheim asked what industrialization does to the **division of labour**.

- All societies must perform certain functions — security, political leadership, spiritual leadership
- What differs is the **complexity** of the division of labour that performs them
- Simple societies need little complexity to hold order; industrial capitalism forces functional differentiation

Anomie. Older certainties — God above all — are called into question by science and technology, producing **a widespread sense of rootlessness**, and with it criminality and social violence.

Parsons: traditional and modern as ideal types

Table 3.1 · Traditional vs. modern societies

	Traditional societies	Modern societies
How is social status determined?	Ascriptive status	Achievement status
What social roles do people play?	Diffuse roles	Specific roles
Are values universal or case-dependent?	Particularistic values	Universalistic values
Which matters more, group or individual?	Collectivity orientation	Self-orientation
Immediate reward, or postponed for future benefit?	Affectivity	Affective neutrality

These are **ideal types anchoring a continuum**, not descriptions. **No society is purely one or the other** — every real society sits somewhere between.

Lipset: the strong claim

In *Political Man* (1959) Lipset argued for a **direct relationship** between industrialization and political democracy.

- Economic modernization creates the **social requisites** of democracy: a large, vibrant, literate middle class, and wealth
- He found direct correlations between democracy and higher **urbanization**, higher **literacy**, and greater **per capita income**

From correlation he concluded causation: economic development has **a direct causal relationship with political democracy**.

Deutsch: not democracy — mobilization

Karl Deutsch (1961) accepted the disruption but refused Lipset's conclusion.

the process in which the major cluster of old social, economic and psychological commitments are eroded or broken and people become available for new patterns of socialization and behavior
— Deutsch (1961, p. 494), defining **social mobilization**

Industrialization moved populations from countryside to city. People who had identified with a locality now made new acquaintances, learned new things, and questioned their own identity — which is how **national** identities emerged.

Politically, mobilization expands “the politically relevant strata of the population” — **those persons who must be taken into account**. Whether that ends in stability or disorder depends on how the existing system copes.

Almond and Coleman: five crises

Economic modernization creates **crises** a political system must resolve. What results depends on how it copes.

Crisis	What it is
Identity	Local ties break; a new sense of community — usually national — must form
Legitimacy	Divine right gives way to the idea that rule rests on the consent of the governed
Participation	A “revolution in rising expectations” generates demands to take part in governing
Penetration	New institutions must link rulers to ruled directly, replacing indirect rule through nobles
Distribution	New social groups demand their material share of the economic pie

What is “political development”?

The term does not mean one thing, and the disagreement matters.

Lipset

A politically developed state is one that is **democratic**.

Beer (1973)

Development is the **expansion of the bureaucratic state** — patterns of interests create patterns of power, which generate new interests, *ad infinitum*.

Huntington (1965, 1968)

Development is **political institutionalization**: “the process by which organizations and procedures acquire value and stability.”

Notice what follows. On Beer’s and Huntington’s definitions, **a country can develop politically without becoming any more democratic.**

Huntington's four dimensions

How do you tell whether a political system is institutionalized?

Dimension	The question
Adaptability / rigidity	Can it survive a change in its environment?
Complexity / simplicity	Is there a division of labour, with redundant structures?
Autonomy / subordination	Is it independent of any single social group?
Coherence / disunity	Is there a unity of purpose holding it together?

Adaptability has three measures: **chronological age**, **generational age** (how many leadership transitions), and **functional age** (how many times it has changed what it does).

Check: what does institutionalization measure?

Huntington's **generational age** measures a system's adaptability by counting:

- The number of years since the organization was founded
- The number of leadership transitions it has been through
- The number of times it has changed its function
- The number of social groups it represents

The second. A system can be chronologically ancient and still fragile if **one leader has never been replaced**.

Two variables, four outcomes

Table 3.2 · Huntington's classification of regime types

	Institutionalization high	Institutionalization low
Social mobilization high	Civic	Corrupt (praetorian)
Social mobilization low	Contained	Primitive

Table 3.3 · Country examples

	Institutionalization high	Institutionalization low
Social mobilization high	The United States · Great Britain · the Soviet Union	Most of the developing world
Social mobilization low	Contained — perhaps colonial societies	Traditional agrarian monarchies (Imperial Ethiopia)

Outcomes are the product of the **interaction** of the two, not of either alone. Mobilization without institutions is **not development but decay**.

The entry that should stop you

The Soviet Union is filed under **civic** — beside the United States and Great Britain.

Ishiyama's reasoning: the USSR modernized massively and fast in the 1930s, generating extensive mobilization pressure. The system was **complex, autonomous**, and armed with a legitimising ideology, so it met those demands — or contained them by repression and violence — and survived.

Britain and the United States built institutions **before** industrialization, which Chapter 2 treated as something close to a historical accident. The Soviet Union built the state and transformed the economy at the same time — **rather like building a ship in a stormy sea.**

Modernization theory in summary

Whatever version, three commitments recur:

1. Political development is a **consequence** of economic development — the political system evolves in response to economic stimuli
2. The approaches rest on **historical observation of the West**, particularly Europe
3. The key intervening variable is often **political culture** — the subject of Chapter 4

Point 2 is the opening dependency theory will attack, and **it is the same parochialism Macridis complained about in Chapter 1.**

Part 2: Dependency

A different room, a different answer

While modernization theory developed among North American political scientists, a rival grew in post-war **Latin America**, rooted in neo-Marxism and dissatisfied with the international economic order.

Prebisch (1950)	Research at ECLA: falling wealth in poor countries correlates with rising wealth in rich ones
Baran (1957) · Frank (1966, 1967)	International capitalism produced the de-development of the developing world
dos Santos (1970)	A “new dependency” — external relations are <i>articulated</i> internally
Cardoso	Growing disparities between centre and periphery, written in exile
Wallerstein (2004)	The “World System” and the history of international capitalism

The development of underdevelopment

Frank's claim, introduced to an American audience in 1966: poverty in the developing world is **not** a starting condition that development will cure. It is a **product** of world capitalism.

The Indian textile case. Before the British East India Company, textile production — largely household industry — employed a great many people and was extensive. Cheap manufactured imports followed the British, **destroyed the indigenous industry, and created mass unemployment and poverty.**

So the periphery is not “behind.” It was actively **de-developed**.

Two more breaks with modernization theory

- 1 · **The international system is missing.** Modernization theory explains development by internal structural factors, with no reference to the international environment.
- 2 · **The Western path is assumed repeatable.** Marx himself wrote, in the 1867 preface to *Das Kapital*, that “the country that is more developed industrially only shows, to the less developed, the image of its own future.”

Dependency's reply: the West industrialized **before** the world capitalist system consolidated — indeed the West created it. Countries developing now face **an obstacle their predecessors never had to pass.**

Figure 3.1 · Imperialism, nineteenth century

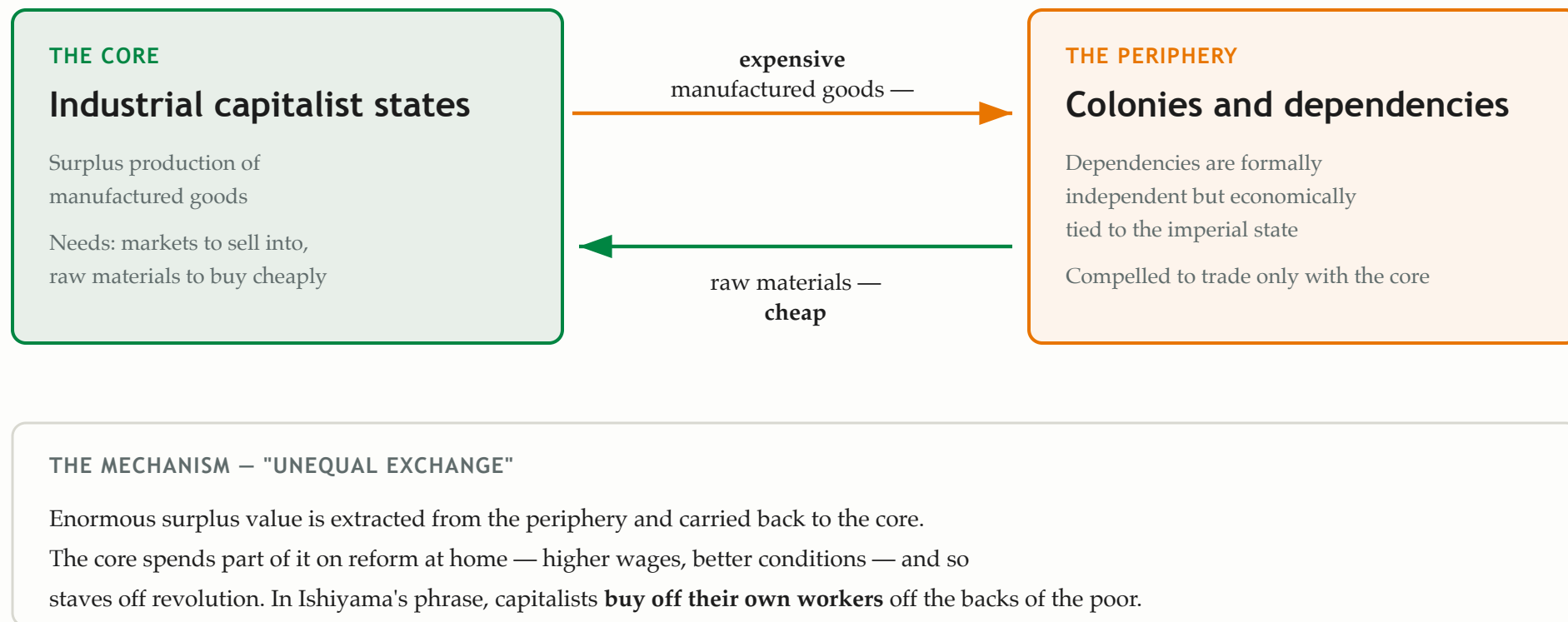


Figure 1: Recreated from Ishiyama, Figure 3.1. Click to enlarge.

Figure 3.2 · Neo-imperialism, twentieth century

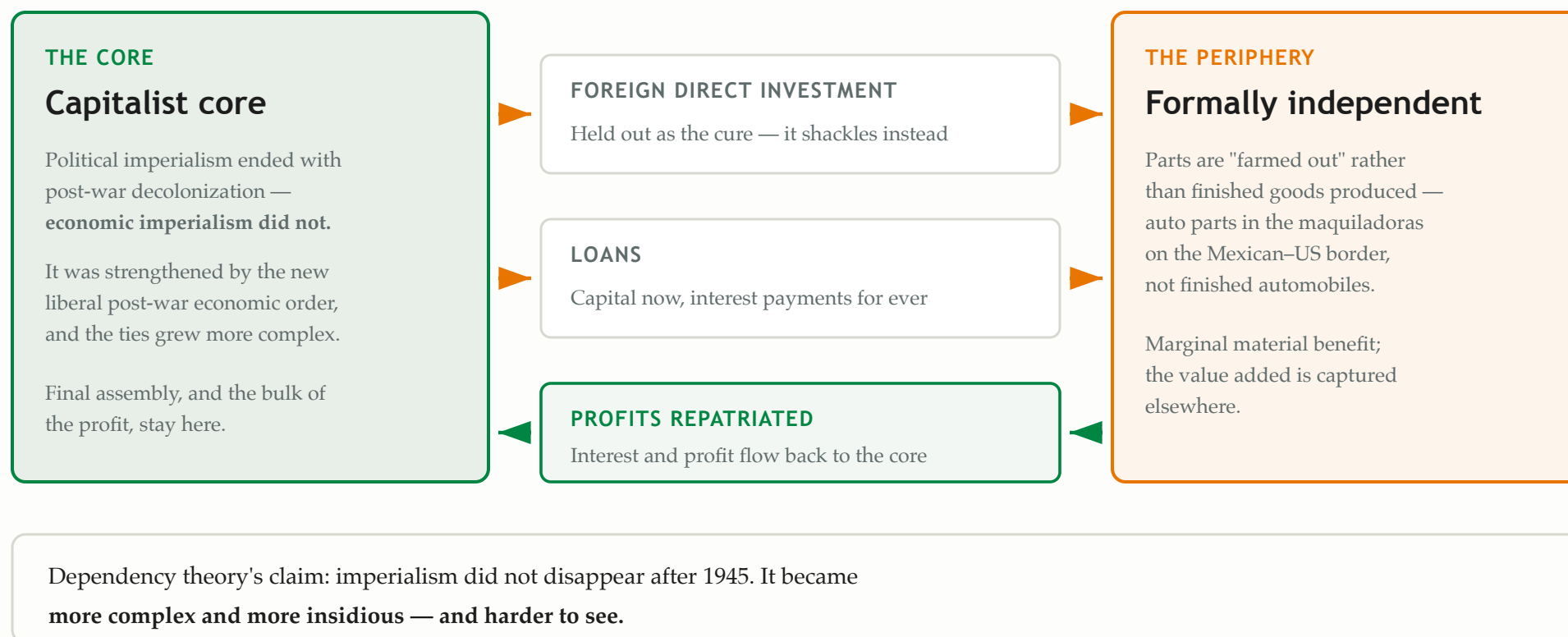


Figure 2: Recreated from Ishiyama, Figure 3.2. FDI, foreign direct investment. Click to enlarge.

Figure 3.3 · The internal articulation

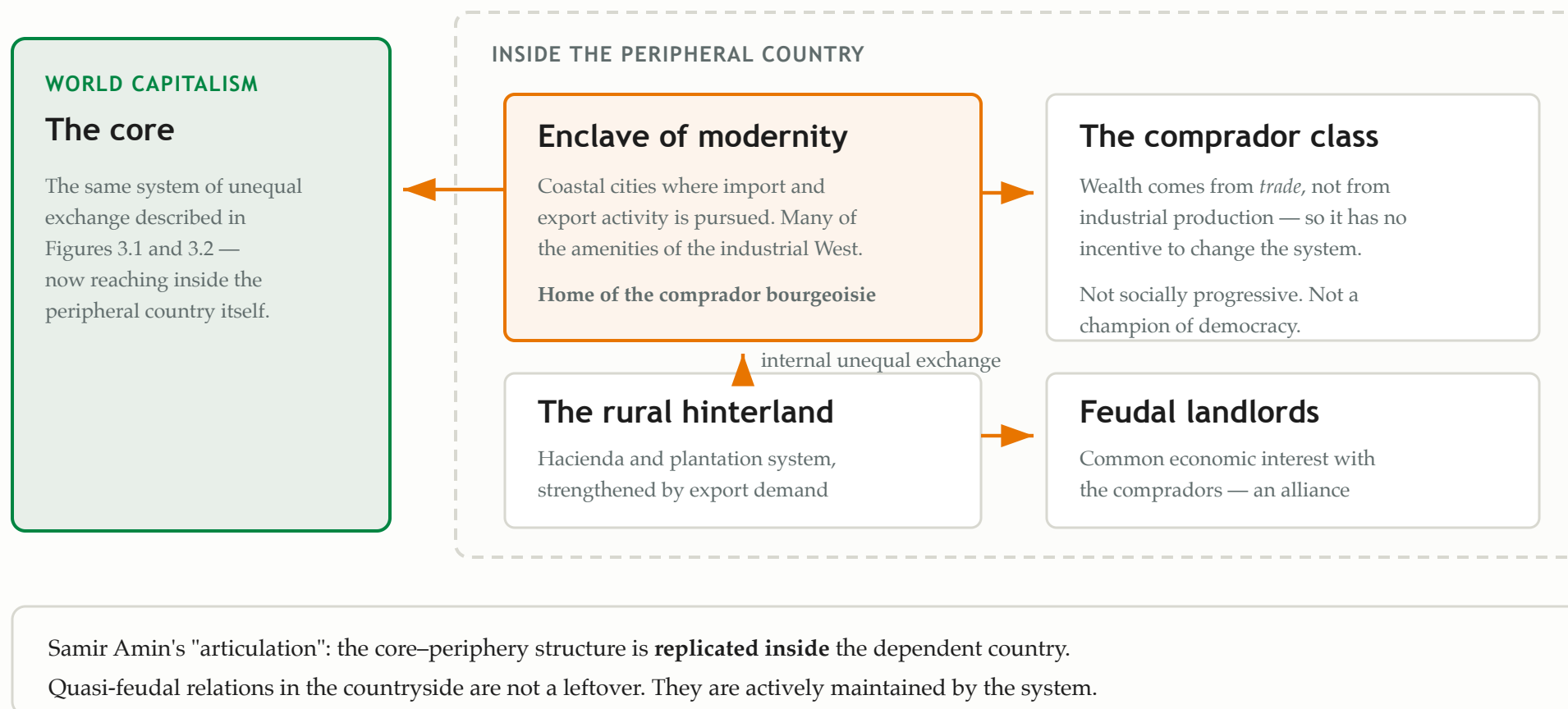


Figure 3: Recreated from Ishiyama, Figure 3.3. Click to enlarge.

Why dependency implies authoritarianism

In the West the bourgeoisie was the **progressive** class — it dismantled feudalism and opened the way to democracy.

In the periphery the comprador bourgeoisie is nothing of the kind. Its wealth comes from **trade**, not industrial production, so it has no reason to change the system, and every reason to keep the masses unempowered.

And if a populist leader does emerge from the masses — usually through the ranks of the military — he is likely to reject bourgeois democracy as Western and corrupt. So from this perspective there is **little hope for democracy while dependent relations persist.**

Check: what does “de-development” claim?

- Poor countries have not yet begun the development process
- Poverty in the periphery is a product of the expansion of world capitalism, not a starting condition
- Development stalls because peripheral states adopt the wrong values
- Peripheral countries will eventually resemble the core, as classical Marxists expected

The second. **The periphery is not behind. It was actively made poor.**

Part 3: Statism

The anomaly

Classical dependency says the periphery can never catch up. But some countries plainly did.

Japan · Russia · Turkey, and more recently the Asian Tigers — **Taiwan, Singapore, South Korea.**

Scholars trained in the dependency tradition — **Evans, Rueschemeyer, Skocpol** — began to question whether dependency travelled beyond Latin America. Some peripheral countries were catching up, and doing it through **state-led industrialization.**

What both other theories missed

The statist critique: modernization theory and dependency theory are both **society-centred**. Each ignores the role the state itself plays in capital accumulation and investment.

Liberal state

An **arena** in which interests compete.

Marxist state

A **tool** of the dominant class.

Weberian state

“A human community which claims the monopoly of the legitimate use of physical force within a given territory.”

In the first two the state is an **object with no interests of its own**. For Weber it is a community — so it has interests, and **the paramount one is survival**.

Politics as the cause

What drives a state to modernize is **the threat posed by external enemies**. Rapid industrialization raises military capacity, and military capacity buys security.

So the arrow reverses. For modernization theory politics reflects internal economic change; for dependency it reflects external economic structure. For statism, **politics is a cause of economic transformation**.

Part 4: Comparing the three

Table 3.4 · The three approaches compared

	Modernization theory	Dependency	Statism
Unit of analysis	State	Global system	State
Can earlier models be replicated?	Yes	No	Yes
Economic development is possible...	when modern values are adopted	only when the international economic order changes	as the result of voluntaristic action by the state

Read the middle row as the fault line. If earlier models **cannot** be replicated, then every reform proposal built on a Western template is **answering the wrong question**.

Check: whose unit of analysis?

Which approach takes the **global system** rather than the state as its unit of analysis?

- Modernization theory
- Dependency theory
- Statism
- All three, since each studies countries in an international context

Dependency. **For modernization theory and statism alike the unit is the state** — development is a function of what happens inside a country's borders, or of what its state chooses to do.

Where this leaves the argument

Ishiyama's own summing up: there is broad consensus that the economic environment is **a crucial explanatory factor** for the emergence of political forms, including democracy — while the debate over how it matters remains open.

Chapter 4 turns to the variable modernization theory kept treating as the intervening step: **political culture**.

For your dossier

Round 2 asks for a context diagnosis including **political economy**. This chapter gives you three incompatible ways to write that section.

Three things to try this week:

- Ask which of the three approaches your **focal country's** trajectory best fits — and which one your comparator fits. If they differ, that difference *is* your Round 3 argument
- Locate your focal country on Huntington's two dimensions. Is its problem mobilization, institutionalization, or the gap between them?
- If your team is drawn to a structural explanation, name the **mechanism** linking structure to politics. Haggard and Kaufman's complaint about structural theories was precisely that the mechanism goes missing